queen – the prince he named Salim.

. Abdul Qadir Badauni, *Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh* (Selections from Histories), vol. 2, trans. W.H. Lowe (first published 1884–98; Atlantic Publishers and Distributors, 1990).

. Nizamuddin Ahmad, 'Tabakat-i Akbari', in *The History of India, As Told by Its Own Historians*, trans. H.M. Elliot, vol. 5 (Trübner and Co., 1873).

. Abu'l Fazl, *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl* (completed by Inayatullah), vol. 2, trans. Henry Beveridge (First published 1902–1939; Low Price Publications, 2017). Badauni's version of events supports Nizamuddin's.

. Col. G.B. Malleson, *Akbar and the Rise of the Mughal Empire* (Clarendon Press, 1908).

. Badauni, *Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh*, trans. W.H. Lowe.

. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 2.

. Ibid.

. From July 1564, when Akbar set out against Abdullah the Uzbek in Malwa, to June 1567, when he defeated Ali Quli and Bahadur.

. Akbar 'killed a thousand animals in sport', Nizamuddin reports.

. Lt-Col. James Tod, *Annals and Antiquities of Rajasthan, or the Central and Western Rajput States of India*, vol. 1, ed. William Crooke (Oxford University Press, 1920). Other later historians have agreed, broadly, with this claim, though in less florid terms. Thus, for example, Michael H. Fisher writes: 'Historically

. . . many martial immigrants (from elsewhere in South Asia or from Central Asia) claimed Rajput status after they had settled or conquered and became local landholders or rulers.' See Michael H. Fisher, *A Short History of the Mughal Empire* (I.B. Tauris, 2016).

. William Crooke in his introduction to Tod, *Annals and Antiquities of Rajasthan*, vol. 1.

. Richard M. Eaton, *India in the Persianate Age: 1000–1765* (Allen Lane, 2019). Eaton uses a fascinating episode from an early fifteenth-century Sanskrit poem, the *Hammira Mahakavya*, both to explain the 'crystallization' of Rajput identity as 'territorially based, closed clans . . . nurturing a warrior ethos' in the sixteenth century onwards, and to demonstrate how fluid this identity was previously.

Thus, the *Hammira Mahakavya* describes a fourteenth-century soldier called Muhammad Shah ('Mahimasahi') 'transitioning from an ethnic Mongol, to an Indian Muslim, and finally to a kshatriya warrior'. Muhammad Shah comes to the Delhi Sultanate from Central Asia in the late thirteenth century; participates in a conquest of Gujarat in 1299; then rebels with fellow Mongols and finds refuge in Ranthambore, ruled by Hammira, last of the Chauhans. When the then sultan, Alauddin Khilji, besieges Ranthambore, Muhammad Shah kills his own family before going out into his final battle. He is found wounded by Khilji, who offers him his life, but Muhammad Shah refuses to submit. So he dies: the Mongol vowing allegiance to the Chauhan with his last breath.

. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 3.

. Possibly from Paramara rulers.

. As Tod writes, 'The close of Bappa's career is the strangest part of the legend.' This is how it goes: 'Advanced in years, [Bappa Rawal] abandoned his children and his country, carried his arms west to Khorasan, and there established himself, and married new wives from among the "barbarians", by whom he had numerous offspring.' Thus, he battled and defeated 'all the kings of the west, as in Ispahan, Kandahar, Kashmir, Irak, Iran, Turan, and Kafiristan', married all their daughters 'by whom he had one hundred and thirty sons, called the Nausshahra Pathans'. When Bappa Rawal died, having lived a full hundred years, the legendary king was buried at the foot of the legendary Mount Meru.

. Tod, *Annals and Antiquities of Rajasthan*, vol. 1.